

Jeffrey G. Chase

Lead Architect · Senior Java Engineer · CI/CD & Legacy Modernization

Raleigh, NC · open to remote contract · Jeff@JeffreyGChase.dev

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SUMMARY

Lead architect and senior Java engineer with 23 years building and modernizing enterprise systems, most recently 12 years at MetLife leading architecture for ~30 Group Life administration applications. Hands-on in Java/Spring, CI/CD pipeline design (Azure DevOps, Bamboo, Jenkins), containerized delivery to OpenShift and Docker Swarm, and modernization of mainframe DB2 and WebSphere systems. Defense modeling background supporting Northrop Grumman and the Missile Defense Agency; M.S. in Physics. Uses AI coding assistants (Claude, GitHub Copilot) in daily engineering work. Seeking remote contract roles.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages	Java, SQL, C#, C/C++, Groovy, JavaScript, Python, Fortran
Frameworks & APIs	Spring/Spring Boot, REST, OpenAPI, SOAP, .NET Core, Blazor, Angular, JUnit, Cucumber
CI/CD & Build	Azure DevOps, Bamboo, Jenkins, TeamCity, UrbanCode, Maven, Gradle, Git Flow, Liquibase
Platforms	OpenShift, Docker Swarm, WebSphere/Liberty, JBoss/Tomcat, WebLogic, RHEL, AIX, Solaris
Data	DB2 (mainframe), Oracle, MS SQL Server, PostgreSQL, Entity Framework
Quality & Security	Veracode, SonarQube, Artifactory, Splunk (SPL), AppDynamics
Ways of Working	SAFe / Agile, Scrum Master, onshore / offshore team leadership, mentoring

EXPERIENCE

MetLife, Inc. Cary, NC

Aug 2014 – Jun 2026

Lead Architect

Nov 2021 – Jun 2026

- Architect for ~30 Group Life administration applications in the Employer Case Set Up & Admin Agile Release Train; accountable for architecture, security posture, and CI/CD strategy across onshore and offshore teams.
- Designed and built Azure DevOps CI/CD pipelines deploying containerized Java applications to OpenShift across DEV → INT → QA → DR → PROD, with reusable templates adopted org-wide with Veracode, SonarQube, Artifactory, and health-gated smoke tests built in.
- Led migration of multiple applications from Atlassian/TFS to Azure DevOps on aggressive timelines; implemented Liquibase pipelines for schema-as-code delivery.
- Drove org-wide Log4j remediation with a reusable decoupling tool; personally delivered multiple production fixes.
- Remediated critical XSS and SQL injection findings in AngularJS/.NET applications; delivered Veracode security training; onboarded four TCS teams and one Cognizant team.

Lead Software Development Engineer

Apr 2019 – Oct 2021

- Technical lead across a \$3M portfolio of ~30 applications with teams of up to 12; led the organization's Waterfall-to-SAFE architecture transition and served as Scrum Master for a team of ten.
- Designed a Blue/Green deployment model on Docker Swarm, automated with Urban Code Deploy and reusable Bitbucket/Bamboo templates; presented it to ~200 engineers and at DevOps Days.
- Built a .NET Core/C#/Blazor rules engine on MS SQL Server that replaced 1,000+ manually managed business rules.
- Built a Java test-automation framework from Postman collections, driving Bamboo functional and regression suites.
- Built a Java regex tool migrating org-wide logging from log4j to slf4j; moved three legacy apps to Docker.
- Mentored six interns across three projects, including a mainframe modernization replacing green screens with an MVC web app (Angular views, Spring/Java controllers, z/OS/DB2 model).

Senior Software Development Engineer

Aug 2014 – Mar 2019

- Technical lead on distributed policy administration systems running on WebSphere across 50 Linux/AIX servers; led an FTE/vendor team on the Oracle Insurance Policy Admin platform.
- Designed a high-performance call center application on WebSphere Liberty in a Docker Swarm platform backed by mainframe DB2, and won stakeholder buy-in to adopt containers.
- Enabled ten-minute production releases via automated post-deploy smoke tests in Bamboo and UrbanCode.
- Built Spring REST services defined in Swagger and secured with API Connect; created Splunk dashboards and drove AppDynamics root-cause analysis.
- Cut the nightly batch trail of 50+ Tivoli jobs from eight hours to two.
- Built a multi-threaded Java tool that validated SQL changes by executing them against 30k policies in ten minutes.
- Migrated online and batch apps from WAS 7/AIX to WAS 8.5.5/RHEL; led the DataPower Ethical Hack remediation.
- Implemented and enforced Git Flow branching across all applications; mentored most of the team on the workflow.

Advanced Systems Engineering Group San Diego, CA

Oct 2007 – Jul 2014

Senior Software Engineer · supporting Northrop Grumman

- Engineered the DoD Joint Effects Model (JEM) and Decision Support System, which model CBRN hazards for warfighters (Java, C++, Fortran; JBoss/Tomcat, SOAP, PostgreSQL).
- Designed a PKI module in Tomcat authenticating Common Access Card users against Active Directory.
- Ported the HPAC Java/C++/Fortran codebase from Windows and 32-bit Solaris WebLogic to 64-bit JBoss on RHEL.
- Bridged legacy Fortran models to OSGi via C++/JNI and JAXB; built OpenLayers/GeoServer WMS map overlays.
- Improved Gaussian puff dispersion algorithm run time by up to 25% through profiling and code refinement.

Sparta, Inc. El Segundo / Laguna Hills, CA

Dec 2003 – Sep 2007

Senior Systems Analyst

- Built missile-tracking filters (EKF, UKF, batch, track merge) in C++ and Fortran 90 for an end-to-end tracking simulation supporting Missile Defense Agency trade studies; presented Monte Carlo benchmarking analyses.
- Integrated multi-threaded C++ algorithms into an MIT Lincoln Lab simulation on a PVM Linux cluster.

Computer Sciences Corporation FAA control tower software

Dec 1997 – Jul 1998

SELECTED PROJECTS

AI Network & Tooling Claude API · Node.js · Discord.js · AWS EC2 · pm2

2025 – 2026

- Built and deployed a live Discord bot integrating the Claude API, with a full pipeline from local development through GitHub to EC2 under pm2 process management.

AskAway askaway.dev · Cloudflare Workers · D1 · Claude API

2026

- Live multi-tenant AI website assistant for small businesses: one Worker serves the REST API and every client page, with streaming responses, per-client rate limiting, and guardrails.
- Node.js tooling provisions clients from JSON configs and grades answers against guardrails with a model-as-judge eval. Designed with an AI assistant (Claude), which wrote most of the code.

NC Lottery Scratch-Offs Analyzer github.com/jeffreygchase/scratch-off-lottery

2020

- Python/BeautifulSoup scraper feeding a Java combinatorics engine that computes probability and expected value across all available scratch-off prizes.

EDUCATION

M.S. Physics, University of Florida · high-energy theory under Pierre Ramond · Physics TA of the Year

B.S. Mathematics, Stockton State College · Graduated with Program Distinction